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[Tennessee Code](#) > [Title 9](#) > [Chapter 21](#) > [Part 2](#) > § 9-21-207

Tennessee Code 9-21-207 – When an election is necessary

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(a) No election upon a proposition for the issuance of general obligation bonds shall be necessary:

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Terms Used In Tennessee Code 9-21-207

- Bonds: means bonds or interim certificates issued pending preparation or delivery of definitive bonds of a local government issued pursuant to this chapter. See [Tennessee Code 9-21-105](#)
- Governing body: means the legislative body of any local government of this state or any other authority charged with the governing of the affairs of any local government in this state. See [Tennessee Code 9-21-105](#)
- Local government: means any county, municipality or metropolitan government in this state. See [Tennessee Code 9-21-105](#)
- Obligation: An order placed, contract awarded, service received, or similar transaction during a given period that will require payments during the same or a future period.
- signed: includes a mark, the name being written near the mark and witnessed, or any other symbol or methodology executed or adopted by a party with intention to authenticate a writing or record, regardless of being witnessed. See [Tennessee Code 1-3-105](#)

(1) If the general obligation bonds are to be issued for water works or sewerage purposes and if the governing body, by a vote of three-fourths (3/4) of its members then in office, determine and declare in the initial resolution that an emergency requires the issuance of such bonds, which determination and declaration shall be conclusive; or

(2) In any case where a petition has not been filed within the time limit specified in [§ 9-21-206](#).

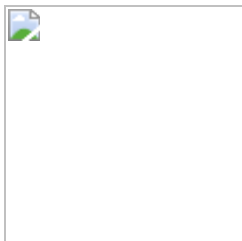
(b) If a petition protesting the issuance of the general obligation bonds signed by at least ten percent (10%) of the registered voters of the local government, determined as of the date of publication of the notice required in [§ 9-21-206](#), or that portion, if applicable, which is liable to be taxed therefor, is filed with the official charged with maintaining the records of the local government within twenty (20) days from the publication of the initial resolution, then no general obligation bonds shall be issued without the assent of the majority of the registered voters in the local government or a portion of the local government, if applicable, voting upon a proposition for the issuance of the general obligation bonds in the manner provided by §§ [9-21-209](#) and 9-21-210. The county election commission shall certify to the local government within fifteen (15) days of receipt by the county election commission of any petition filed hereunder, the total number of registered voters as of the date of publication of the notice and the total number of valid signatures of registered voters signing the petition. Registered voters shall not withdraw their signatures from a petition after signing the petition.

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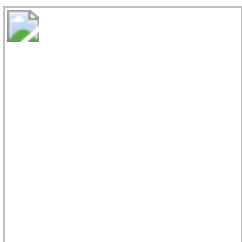


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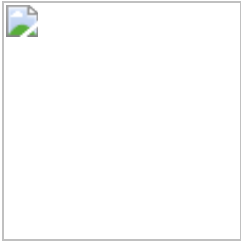


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